

# Addictions in Modern Life

现代生活中的成瘾问题与应对

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Date: 2026-05-17 | Level: A1-A2

English Class Course Material

# Learning Goals

## 学习目标

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- Understand what addiction is and why it happens

理解成瘾是什么以及它为什么会发生

- Learn about dopamine and its role in addiction

了解多巴胺及其在成瘾中的作用

- Understand dopamine fasting and how it works

理解多巴胺禁食及其原理

- Discuss information overload and brain's love for novelty

讨论信息过载和大脑对新鲜感的喜爱

- Practice talking about habits and self-control in English

练习用英语谈论习惯和自控力

# Warm-up Questions

## 课前讨论

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### 1. Do you have any habits that are hard to stop?

你有没有很难戒掉的习惯？

### 2. What things distract you the most in daily life?

日常生活中什么东西最容易分散你的注意力？

### 3. Have you heard of dopamine? What do you know about it?

你听说过多巴胺吗？你知道什么？

### 4. Do you think modern technology makes addiction easier?

你觉得现代科技让成瘾更容易了吗？

# Key Vocabulary

## 核心词汇

| Word             | Pron.                | POS  | Chinese | Example                                                                             |
|------------------|----------------------|------|---------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| addiction        | /ə'dɪkʃən/           | n.   | 成瘾      | Addiction is hard to break.   Phone addiction is common now.                        |
| dopamine         | /'dɒʊpəmi:n/         | n.   | 多巴胺     | Dopamine makes you feel happy.   Social media releases dopamine.                    |
| nicotine         | /'nɪkəti:n/          | n.   | 尼古丁     | Nicotine is in cigarettes.   Nicotine makes smoking addictive.                      |
| caffeine         | /'kæfi:n/            | n.   | 咖啡因     | Coffee has a lot of caffeine.   Caffeine keeps you awake.                           |
| distraction      | /dɪ'strækʃən/        | n.   | 分心事物    | My phone is a big distraction.   Distractions make it hard to focus.                |
| willpower        | /'wɪlpəʊər/          | n.   | 意志力     | It takes willpower to stop.   Willpower is like a muscle.                           |
| FOMO             | /'fəʊmɒʊ/            | n.   | 错失恐惧症   | FOMO makes you check your phone.   FOMO = Fear Of Missing Out.                      |
| novelty          | /'nɒvəlti/           | n.   | 新鲜感     | Our brains love novelty.   Novelty makes things exciting.                           |
| fast             | /fɑ:st/              | v.   | 禁食（动词）  | I fast from social media on weekends.   Dopamine fasting means stopping fun things. |
| dopamine fasting | /'dɒʊpəmi:n fɑ:stɪŋ/ | n.   | 多巴胺禁食   | Dopamine fasting helps reset your brain.   Try dopamine fasting for one day.        |
| reward           | /rɪ'wɔ:rd/           | n.   | 奖励      | Your brain sees sugar as a reward.   Dopamine is a reward chemical.                 |
| succeed          | /sək'si:d/           | v.   | 成功      | You can succeed if you keep trying.   She succeeded in quitting smoking.            |
| boring           | /'bɔ:ɪŋ/             | adj. | 无聊的     | Life feels boring without your phone.   Boring tasks need willpower.                |
| overcome         | /'əʊvər'kʌm/         | v.   | 克服      | You can overcome addiction.   She overcame her fear of speaking.                    |
| habit            | /'hæbɪt/             | n.   | 习惯      | Checking your phone is a habit.   Good habits help you succeed.                     |
| screen time      | /skri:n taɪm/        | n.   | 屏幕时间    | My screen time is 6 hours a day.   Reduce your screen time before bed.              |
| social media     | /'səʊʃəl mi:diə/     | n.   | 社交媒体    | Social media can be addictive.   I spend too much time on social media.             |

### Additional Example Sentences

#### 扩展例句

**addiction** /ə'dɪkʃən/ n.

成瘾

Video game addiction is a growing problem. | He struggled with alcohol addiction for years.

游戏成瘾是一个日益严重的问题。| 他与酒精成瘾挣扎了多年。

**dopamine** /'dɒʊpəmi:n/ n.

多巴胺

Dopamine is a chemical in your brain. | Eating sweet food releases dopamine.

多巴胺是大脑中的一种化学物质。| 吃甜食会释放多巴胺。

**nicotine** /'nɪkəti:n/ n.

尼古丁

Nicotine is one of the most addictive substances. | Nicotine patches can help you quit smoking.

尼古丁是最容易让人成瘾的物质之一。| 尼古丁贴片可以帮你戒烟。

**caffeine /'kæfi:n/ n.**

咖啡因

Too much caffeine can cause anxiety. | Tea also contains caffeine.

咖啡因摄入过多会导致焦虑。| 茶也含有咖啡因。

**distraction /dɪ'strækʃən/ n.**

分心事物

Notifications are a constant distraction. | I study in the library to avoid distractions.

通知是持续的干扰。| 我在图书馆学习以避免分心。

**willpower /'wɪlpəʊər/ n.**

意志力

Willpower helps you resist temptation. | Some people have more willpower than others.

意志力帮你抵抗诱惑。| 有些人意志力比别人强。

**FOMO /'fəʊmɒʊ/ n.**

错失恐惧症

FOMO makes people check social media constantly. | Don't let FOMO control your life.

FOMO让人不停刷社交媒体。| 不要让FOMO控制你的生活。

**novelty /'nɒvəlti/ n.**

新鲜感

The novelty of a new phone wears off quickly. | Children love the novelty of new toys.

新手机的新鲜感很快就会消失。| 孩子们喜欢新玩具的新鲜感。

**fast /fɑ:st/ v.**

禁食（动词）

I fast from sugar for one week. | People fast from social media to reset their brain.

我禁糖一周。| 人们禁社交媒体来重置大脑。

**dopamine fasting /'dɒpəmi:n fɑ:stɪŋ/ n.**

多巴胺禁食

Dopamine fasting means avoiding highly stimulating activities. | Try dopamine fasting on a Sunday.

多巴胺禁食意味着避免高刺激活动。| 试试周日做多巴胺禁食。

**reward /rɪ'wɔ:rd/ n.**

奖励

Your brain treats social media likes as a reward. | A good meal can be a reward after hard work.

大脑把社交媒体的点赞当作奖励。| 一顿美餐是努力工作后的奖励。

**succeed /sək'si:d/ v.**

成功

Many people succeed in breaking bad habits. | He succeeded after three attempts.

很多人成功改掉了坏习惯。| 他尝试了三次后成功了。

**boring /'bɔ:ɪŋ/ adj.**

无聊的

Reading can seem boring at first. | Without your phone, everything feels boring.

读书一开始可能觉得无聊。| 没有手机，什么都觉得无聊。

**overcome /,oʊvər'kʌm/ v.**

克服

She overcame her shopping addiction. | You can overcome any habit with patience.

她克服了购物瘾。| 有耐心就能克服任何习惯。

**habit /'hæbɪt/ n.**

习惯

Brushing teeth is a good habit. | Bad habits are hard to break.

刷牙是好习惯。| 坏习惯很难改掉。

**screen time /skri:n taɪm/ n.**

屏幕时间

Doctors say screen time should be under 2 hours. | I track my screen time every day.

医生说屏幕时间应少于2小时。| 我每天记录屏幕时间。

**social media /'səʊʃəl mi:diə/ n.**

社交媒体

Social media is designed to be addictive. | Taking a break from social media is healthy.

社交媒体被设计成让人成瘾的。| 远离社交媒体一段时间是健康的。

# Useful Expressions

## 实用表达

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### Describing addictive behaviors

描述成瘾行为

**A:**

I can't stop checking my phone every five minutes.

我每五分钟就忍不住看手机。

**B:**

That sounds like phone addiction. You should try dopamine fasting.

这听起来像手机成瘾。你应该试试多巴胺禁食。

**A:**

I know it's bad for me, but I just can't stop.

我知道这对我不好，但就是停不了。

**B:**

Addiction is like that. Your brain wants the dopamine.

成瘾就是这样。你的大脑想要多巴胺。

### Explaining why something is addictive

解释为什么某事物会让人成瘾

**A:**

Why is social media so addictive?

为什么社交媒体这么容易让人成瘾？

**B:**

Because it gives you quick dopamine. Every like or comment is a small reward.

因为它给你快速的多巴胺。每个点赞或评论都是一个小奖励。

**A:**

So easy to get + gives lots of dopamine = addiction?

所以容易获取 + 大量多巴胺 = 成瘾？

**B:**

Exactly. That's the formula for addiction.

没错，这就是成瘾的公式。

## Talking about self-control strategies

谈论自控力策略

**A:**

I want to reduce my screen time. What should I do?

我想减少屏幕时间。我该怎么办？

**B:**

Start by turning off notifications. They are a big distraction.

先关掉通知。它们是很大的干扰。

**A:**

What if I still can't stop?

如果我还是停不了怎么办？

**B:**

Use willpower like a muscle. Start small and build up. You can overcome it.

把意志力当作肌肉来训练。从小处开始，逐渐增强。你能克服它。

## Discussing dopamine fasting

讨论多巴胺禁食

**A:**

Have you ever tried dopamine fasting?

你试过多巴胺禁食吗？

**B:**

Yes, I fasted from social media for one week.

试过，我禁社交媒体一周。

**A:**

What happened after the week?

一周后怎么样？

**B:**

When I used it again, I realized how much time I was wasting. It felt like a reset.

再用的时候，我意识到自己浪费了多少时间。感觉像重置了一样。

## Dialogue / Reading

### 对话与阅读

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#### Scene 1: Introducing the Topic — Distraction & Addiction

场景1：引入话题 — 分心与成瘾

**Teacher:**

Today we're going to talk about addictions. Does anyone know what addiction means?

今天我们要谈谈成瘾。有人知道成瘾是什么意思吗？

**Student A:**

It's like you can't stop doing something?

就是停不了某件事？

**Teacher:**

Yes, exactly. Addictions is like you do something that's maybe not good for you, but you cannot stop.

对，没错。成瘾就是你做的事可能对你不好，但你就是停不了。

**Teacher:**

Can you think of some examples?

你们能想到一些例子吗？

**Student B:**

Smoking? And maybe... coffee?

抽烟？还有……咖啡？

**Student C:**

What about checking your phone all the time?

那一直看手机呢？

**Teacher:**

Very good! All of these are examples of addiction. Let's learn more about why they happen.

很好！这些都是成瘾的例子。让我们了解为什么会这样。

## Scene 2: What Is Addiction? Defining addiction

场景2：什么是成瘾？定义成瘾

**Teacher:**

So what kinds of addiction do people have? Let me give you some examples.

那人们有哪些种类的成瘾？我给你们举些例子。

**Teacher:**

Smoking — nicotine is very addictive. That's why it's so hard to quit.

抽烟 — 尼古丁非常容易让人成瘾。这就是为什么很难戒。

**Teacher:**

Coffee — caffeine is also addictive. Many people need coffee every morning.

咖啡 — 咖啡因也会让人成瘾。很多人每天早上都需要咖啡。

**Teacher:**

Shopping — some people buy things they don't need. That's also an addiction.

购物 — 有些人买自己不需要的东西。那也是一种成瘾。

**Student A:**

I think phone addiction is the biggest one now.

我觉得现在手机成瘾是最严重的。

**Student B:**

And social media! I spend hours on it every day.

还有社交媒体！我每天花好几个小时。

**Teacher:**

Yes, social media and phones are modern addictions. They are everywhere.

是的，社交媒体和手机是现代成瘾。它们无处不在。

## Scene 3: Why Do People Get Addicted? The dopamine mechanism

场景3：为什么会成瘾？多巴胺机制

**Teacher:**

Now, why do people get addicted? There's a chemical in your brain called dopamine.

那为什么会成瘾呢？大脑里有一种化学物质叫多巴胺。

**Teacher:**

They make you feel happy, and this happy thing is quality. Well, this is a bit of a sciencey word. It's called dopamine.

它们让你感到快乐，这种快乐的东西是一种质量。这有点科学，叫做多巴胺。

**Student A:**

So dopamine makes us feel good?

所以多巴胺让我们感觉好？

**Teacher:**

Exactly. When you eat sweet food, your brain releases dopamine. When you get a like on social media, dopamine again.

没错。吃甜食时大脑释放多巴胺。社交媒体上收到点赞，又是多巴胺。

**Teacher:**

The problem is: some things give you too much dopamine too easily.

问题是：有些东西太容易给你太多多巴胺。

**Teacher:**

Easy to get + Gives lots of dopamine = Addiction.

容易获取 + 大量多巴胺 = 成瘾。

**Student B:**

Like scrolling through short videos?

比如刷短视频？

**Teacher:**

Perfect example! Each video is short, new, and exciting. Your brain keeps wanting more dopamine.

完美的例子！每个视频都很短、很新、很刺激。大脑不停想要更多多巴胺。

## Scene 4: Dopamine Fasting — How it works

场景4：多巴胺禁食 — 原理与方法

**Teacher:**

So how can we fight addiction? One way is called dopamine fasting.

那我们怎么对抗成瘾呢？一种方法叫多巴胺禁食。

**Student A:**

What does fasting mean?

fasting是什么意思？

**Teacher:**

Fasting means you stop doing something for a period of time. Like no TV for a week.

Fasting就是你停止做某件事一段时间。比如一周不看电视。

**Teacher:**

If you stop for a week, you drink it and you know, my god, it's so sweet.

如果你停了一周，再喝的时候你会觉得，天哪，这么甜。

**Student B:**

So after fasting, things feel stronger?

所以禁食之后，感觉会更强烈？

**Teacher:**

Yes! Your brain resets. Things that were boring become interesting again.

对！大脑重置了。以前觉得无聊的事变得有意思了。

**Teacher:**

For example, if you stop eating sweet food for a week, an apple tastes amazing.

比如你一周不吃甜食，一个苹果都会觉得特别好吃。

**Student C:**

That sounds hard but worth trying.

听起来很难但值得试试。

**Teacher:**

Start small. Maybe just one day without social media. Use your willpower.

从小处开始。也许就一天不用社交媒体。用你的意志力。

## **Scene 5: Brain & Information Overload — Novelty and too much information**

场景5：大脑与信息过载 — 新鲜感与信息过多

**Teacher:**

There's another reason why we get addicted. Our brains love novelty. We cannot get enough.

还有另一个原因。我们的大脑喜欢新鲜感。永远不够。

**Student A:**

What does novelty mean?

novelty是什么意思？

**Teacher:**

Novelty means something new and different. Your brain loves new things.

Novelty就是新鲜、不同的东西。你的大脑喜欢新东西。

**Teacher:**

That's why you keep scrolling. Every new post is a little bit of novelty.

这就是为什么你不停刮屏幕。每个新帖子都是一点新鲜感。

**Student B:**

But too much information is bad, right?

但信息太多不好，对吧？

**Teacher:**

Yes. Information overload makes your brain tired. You can't focus on anything.

对。信息过载让大脑疲惫。你无法专注任何事情。

**Teacher:**

That's why sometimes you feel tired but you didn't do anything physical. Your brain is exhausted from too much information.

这就是为什么有时你觉得累但并没有做体力活。大脑因信息太多而筋疲力尽。

**Student C:**

So we need to control what information we take in.

所以我们需要控制接收的信息量。

**Teacher:**

Exactly. Be selective. Not everything deserves your attention.

没错。要有选择性。不是所有东西都值得你的注意。

## Guided Practice

### 引导练习

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#### Exercise 1: Fill in the blanks

练习1：填空

Complete the sentences with the correct word from the vocabulary list.

1. \_\_\_\_\_ is a chemical in your brain that makes you feel happy ().

\_\_\_\_\_

2. Cigarettes contain \_\_\_\_\_, which makes them very addictive ().

\_\_\_\_\_

3. Your phone can be a big \_\_\_\_\_ when you try to study (). \_\_\_\_\_

4. It takes a lot of \_\_\_\_\_ to break a bad habit (). \_\_\_\_\_

5. \_\_\_\_\_ means stopping fun activities for a while to reset your brain ().

\_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 2: True or False

练习2：判断对错

Write T (True) or F (False) for each statement.

1. Dopamine is a chemical that makes you feel sad. ( ) \_\_\_\_\_

2. Nicotine and caffeine are both addictive substances. ( ) \_\_\_\_\_

3. Dopamine fasting means doing more fun things. ( ) \_\_\_\_\_

4. Our brains love novelty and always want new information. ( ) \_\_\_\_\_

5. Willpower is not important for overcoming addiction. ( ) \_\_\_\_\_

## Exercise 3: Match the concept to its definition

练习3：匹配概念与定义

Match each concept to its correct definition.

A. Dopamine B. FOMO C. Dopamine fasting D. Novelty E. Willpower

1. A chemical in the brain that makes you feel happy → \_\_\_\_\_

2. Fear of missing out, often caused by social media → \_\_\_\_\_

3. Stopping highly stimulating activities to reset your brain → \_\_\_\_\_

\_\_\_\_\_

4. Something new and different that excites the brain → \_\_\_\_\_

5. The mental strength to resist temptation → \_\_\_\_\_

## Speaking Task

### 口语任务

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#### Task 1: Describe one of your habits

任务1：描述你的一个习惯

Tell your partner about one of your habits. Answer these questions:

- What is the habit?
- Is it a good habit or a bad habit?
- Is it addictive? Why or why not?
- Do you want to change it? Why?

#### Task 2: Explain dopamine fasting

任务2：用简单英语解释多巴胺禁食

Explain dopamine fasting to your partner in simple English. Include:

- What dopamine fasting is
- Why people do it
- One example of dopamine fasting (e.g., no social media for a week)
- What happens after you try it

► Use these words: dopamine, fast, reset, boring, reward, willpower

#### Task 3: Role-play — Bad habit and advice

任务3：角色扮演 — 坏习惯与建议

Student A: You have a bad habit (e.g., too much screen time, too much coffee, shopping addiction).

Student B: Give advice to help your partner overcome the habit.

- ▶ Useful phrases: You should try... / Have you considered... / Why don't you... / It might help to...
- ▶ Key vocabulary: addiction, willpower, overcome, dopamine fasting, distraction, habit

## Review

### 复盘总结

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### Key Takeaways

#### 核心要点

- **Addiction = doing something harmful but you cannot stop**  
成瘾 = 做对自己有害的事但停不了
- **Dopamine is a brain chemical that makes you feel happy and want more**  
多巴胺是大脑化学物质，让你感到快乐并想要更多
- **Easy to get + lots of dopamine = the formula for addiction**  
容易获取 + 大量多巴胺 = 成瘾的公式
- **Dopamine fasting means stopping fun things temporarily to reset your brain**  
多巴胺禁食就是暂时停止快乐的事来重置大脑
- **Our brains love novelty, but too much information causes overload**  
大脑喜欢新鲜感，但信息太多会导致过载

### Self-Check

#### 自我检测

#### 1. Can you explain what dopamine is and why it causes addiction?

你能解释多巴胺是什么以及它为什么会致成瘾吗？

#### 2. Can you describe dopamine fasting in your own words?

你能用自己的话描述多巴胺禁食吗？

#### 3. Can you name three types of addiction and explain why they happen?

你能说出三种成瘾类型并解释它们为什么会发生吗？

# Homework

## 课后练习

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### Writing

#### 写作练习

Write a short paragraph (5-8 sentences) about one habit you want to change and your plan.

- ▶ Use at least 5 vocabulary words from this lesson.
- ▶ Example structure: My habit is... / It is addictive because... / I want to change it because... / My plan is... / I will use willpower to...

### Vocabulary Review

#### 词汇复习

Review all vocabulary words. Write a sentence for each of these words:

- addiction
- dopamine
- willpower
- distraction
- overcome
- habit

### Listening Practice

#### 听力练习

Listen to the class recording again. Write down 3 new expressions you learned.

### Answer Key (Exercises 1-3)

#### 练习答案

Exercise 1: 1. Dopamine 2. nicotine 3. distraction 4. willpower 5. Dopamine fasting

Exercise 2: 1. F 2. T 3. F 4. T 5. F

Exercise 3: 1-A 2-B 3-C 4-D 5-E